

However, for a blog to make money there will need to be a minimum number of regular visitors that can then be translated into revenue. There is no fixed benchmark to determine the ideal number of regular visitors. For a niche up-market topic, it may be sufficient if you are able to attract a handful of visitors. For example, if you are passionate about sailing and wish to write only about sailboats, a small audience may be sufficient to create a steady income. On the other hand, if you are blogging on a wider interest topic like say, celebrities, you may need an audience in the tens of thousands before you can consider monetising your blog.

4.1.4 Building Traffic

The single most important thing that will separate your blog from the rest of the crowd can be reduced to a single word: Traffic. If your blog does not have visitors, there is very little you can do to monetise it. Income from your blog (or Web site for that matter) is a function of traffic—that is, the more the traffic, the more the potential income you can generate. If you are able to consistently increase the number of visitors to your blog your income will grow proportionately. This is a self-stoking cycle. The more visitors you have to your blog, the more you will attract!

All of the techniques discussed in this Fast Track contribute to building traffic. However, all these are secondary to the primary point of importance: high quality, focused content.

Building a blog with high quality content is the only sure-fire way to ensure that you attract traffic that will consistently grow. High quality content is something that will engage your users and want them to revisit your site again and again. This means that you will need to take the time and effort to think through each of your postings and to set high standards for yourself.

In the beginning, when you start out, the focus can be less on quality and more on just making sure that you meet your posting schedule. This is because for most bloggers the main problem is not about delivering quality content but the commitment to